METHODOLOGY DOCUMENT
MSCI SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE

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MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Opportunities in Renewable Energy Key Issue

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Introduction

This document provides essential information on the components of the Opportunities in Renewable Energy Key Issue to enable users of ESG Ratings to understand how MSCI Sustainability & Climate's (MSCI S&C's)[1] outputs are determined. Opportunities in Renewable Energy is a Key Issue in the Environmental Pillar of the MSCI ESG Ratings model. Companies are evaluated on their positioning to meet market demand for renewable power through capacity additions and network expansion.

For additional details on the MSCI ESG Ratings Model, refer to the Data, ratings and scores section of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Exhibit 1: MSCI ESG Key Issue hierarchy

3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Environmental	Climate Change	Carbon Emissions
		Climate Change Vulnerability
		Financing Environmental Impact
		Product Carbon Footprint
	Natural Capital	Biodiversity & Land Use
		Raw Material Sourcing
		Water Stress
	Pollution & Waste	Electronic Waste
		Packaging Material & Waste
		Toxic Emissions & Waste
	Environmental Opportunities	Opportunities in Clean Tech
		Opportunities in Green Building
		Opportunities in Renewable Energy
Social	Human Capital	Health & Safety
		Human Capital Development
		Labor Management
		Supply Chain Labor Standards
	Product Liability	Chemical Safety
		Consumer Financial Protection
		Privacy & Data Security
		Product Safety & Quality
		Responsible Investment
	Stakeholder Opposition	Community Relations
		Controversial Sourcing
	Social Opportunities	Access to Finance
		Access to Health Care
		Opportunities in Nutrition & Health

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3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Governance	Corporate Governance	Board
		Pay
		Ownership & Control
		Accounting
	Corporate Behavior	Business Ethics
		Tax Transparency

Opportunities associated with this Key Issue

- Increased revenues from utilizing public subsidies.
- Increased revenue due to changing consumer demand.
- Increased access to markets due to renewable power generation mandates (state, national or regional objectives).
- Increased market share in specific market segments due to early-mover status.

Opportunities in Renewable Energy Key Issue score

The Opportunities in Renewable Energy Key Issue score evaluates the company's level of exposure to, and management of, opportunities on this Key Issue. The Key Issue score on this Key Issue is based on the Exposure score and the Management score using the formula below. The Exposure score and the Management score are combined such that the Exposure score determines the weight placed on the Management score, ranging from 50% (when the Exposure score is equal to zero) to 100% (when the Exposure score is equal to 10).

$$KI_i = \left(\left(\frac{EXP_i}{20} + .5\right) \times MGMT_i\right) + \left(\left(.5 - \frac{EXP_i}{20}\right) \times 5\right)$$

Where:

- KI_i is the Key Issue score for company i.
- EXP_i is the Exposure score for company i.
- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score for company i.

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Opportunities in Renewable Energy Management Framework

The table below outlines the indicators mapped to their respective components that inform the Opportunities in Renewable Energy Management score. MSCI S&C assigned each indicator a default weight. Indicator weights may be adjusted at the company level to reflect the relevance of the indicator to the company's business activities. If a company has no exposure to the business activities covered by an indicator, the indicator is assigned a weight of zero.

Component	Sustainability Indicator
Opportunities in Renewable Energy Strategy score	Targets to increase renewable capacity
	Internal structures to develop renewable capacity
	Investments to increase connection of renewable power to electric grid
	Score of planned additional renewable electricity generation relative to current total capacity
Opportunities in Renewable Energy Programs & Initiatives score	Commercializes renewable power equipment
	Offers customers a green power option
Opportunities in Renewable Energy Performance score	Renewable power capacity performance relative to peers

Opportunities in Renewable Energy Management score

The Opportunities in Renewable Energy Management score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to opportunities on this Key Issue. It is based on weighted average of the score associated with each relevant indicator.

This score is derived from indicators that are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to best practice. Refer to the Analyzing risk management section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. Sources are company disclosures except where otherwise indicated.

The following formula is used to calculate the Opportunities in Renewable Energy Management score:

$$MGMT_i = \sum Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

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- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score - Excluding Controversies for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.

The following formula is used to calculate the scores for the components

$$COMP_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_{c,i}$ is the component score for component c, for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$ is the scaled weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The following formula is used to calculate the weights for the components

$$COMP_Weight_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_Weight_{c,i}$ is the component weight for component c for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The definitions of the data points in each component are given below:

Opportunities in Renewable Energy Strategy score

The Opportunities in Renewable Energy Strategy score evaluates the company's initiatives to expand renewable energy capacity through strategic investments, internal structures, and quantitative targets. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Targets to increase renewable capacity**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has disclosed quantitative targets to increase renewable energy capacity. Includes targets referring to owned capacity only, i.e., excluding purchasing agreements. Applies to companies with an electricity generation business only.

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- **Internal structures to develop renewable capacity**

Definition: Assesses the company's established internal structures related to developing renewable capacity. Best practice is to have a dedicated renewable energy subsidiary or be wholly involved in renewables. Applies to companies with an electricity generation business only.

- **Investments to increase connection of renewable power to electric grid**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has made investments related to the increased connection of renewable power to the electric grid. Applies to companies with an electricity transmission or distribution business only.

- **Score of planned additional renewable electricity generation relative to current total capacity**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on ratio of planned additional renewable electricity generation to current total capacity. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance.

    - **Current Total Installed Capacity (MW)**

Definition: The current amount of installed capacity for power generation in megawatts (MW).

    - **Additional renewable capacity (MW)**

Definition: The amount of capacity in megawatts (MW) that an issuer has disclosed as planned additions which are renewables.

Opportunities in Renewable Energy Programs & Initiatives score

The Opportunities in Renewable Energy Programs & Initiatives score evaluates the company's initiatives to expand renewable energy opportunities through customer green power options and commercialization of renewable power equipment. It is expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Commercializes renewable power equipment**

Definition: Indicates whether the company implements programs that involve the installation of equipment used in renewable energy generation.

- **Offers customers a green power option**

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Definition: Indicates whether the company offers its customers the option to purchase power from renewable generation sources. Applies to companies with an electricity supply business only.

Opportunities in Renewable Energy Performance score

The Opportunities in Renewable Energy Performance score evaluates the company's performance on opportunities in renewable energy metrics (including renewable capacity and percentage change in the proportion of renewable capacity to total generation capacity) relative to its peers. It is expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance.

- **Renewable power capacity performance relative to peers**

Definition: Assesses the company's performance on total renewable energy power capacity (as a percentage of total installed capacity), and trend in renewable energy power capacity, relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0-10 score, where 10 indicates the highest level of performance.

  - **Renewable power capacity (% of total installed capacity) score**

    Definition: Assesses the company's performance on installed renewable power capacity expressed (as a percentage of total installed capacity). Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

    - **Three-year average renewable power capacity (% of total installed capacity)**

      Definition: Measures the company's three-year average installed renewable capacity (as a percentage of total installed capacity).

  - **Renewable power capacity (% of total installed capacity) industry relative trend score**

    Definition: Assesses the company's three-year average of year-over-year installed renewable power capacity (as a percentage of total installed capacity) trend, relative to its peers. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong performance.

    - **Three-year average renewable power capacity trend (% of total installed capacity)**

      Definition: Measures the company's three-year average of year-over-year installed renewable capacity (as a percentage of total installed capacity) trend.

Opportunities in Renewable Energy Exposure score

The Opportunities in Renewable Energy Exposure score evaluates the company's exposure to opportunities on this Key Issue. It is based on the Business and Geographic Exposure scores. The Geographic Exposure score functions as a multiplier on the Business Exposure score, with an impact ranging from -50% to +50%. The Business and Geographic Exposure scores are scored on a 0-10 scale,

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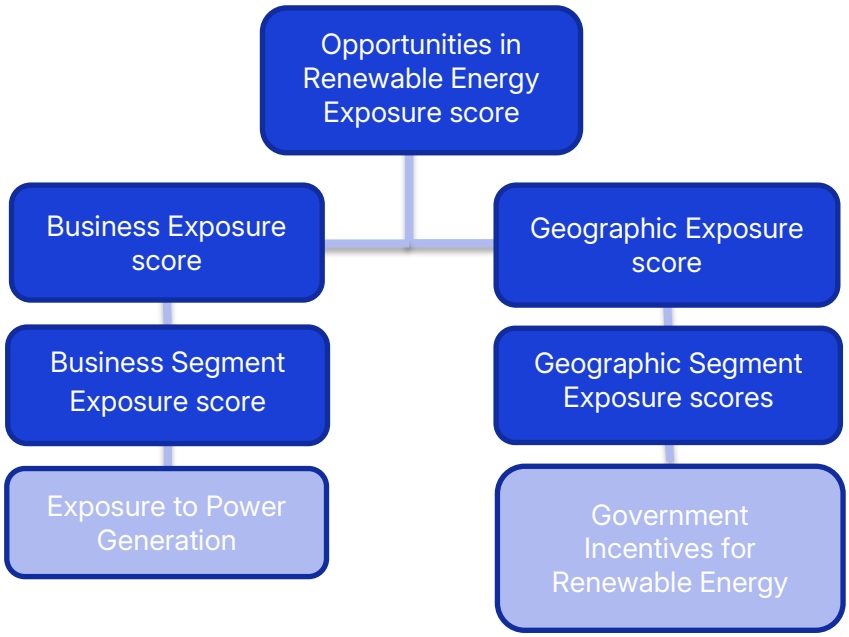
with 10 corresponding to the highest opportunity and 0 corresponding to the lowest opportunity. Refer to the Analyzing risk exposure section of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. The following formula is used in the Exposure score calculation:

$$EXP_{ORE,i} = BUS_{ORE,i}(1 + 0.1(GEO_{ORE,i} - 5))$$

Where:

- $EXP_{ORE,i}$ is the Opportunities in Renewable Energy Exposure score of company i.
- $BUS_{ORE,i}$ is the Business Exposure score of company i.
- $GEO_{ORE,i}$ is the Geographic Exposure score of company i.

Exhibit 2: Exposure score components



Business Exposure score

The Business Exposure score is a weighted average of the Business Segment Exposure scores of a company's business segments. Scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total revenue in each business segment using the following formula to calculate the Business Exposure score:

$$BUS_{ORE,i} = \sum_{j=1}^{n_i} w_{Revenue,i,j} BSE_{ORE,j}$$

Where:

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- $BSE_{ORE,j}$ is the Business Segment Exposure score for the business segment j.
- $w_{Revenue,i,j}$ is the weight of business segment j for company i based on the contribution to total company revenue.
- n_i is the number of business segments of company i.

Business Segment Exposure scores

The Business Segment Exposure score of a business segment is based on a mapping of the business segment as disclosed by the company to a corresponding business activity. MSCI S&C uses the Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) system along with industry-specific adjustments to define business activities. The score associated with a business activity is used to calculate a Business Segment Exposure score. The Business Segment Exposure score is determined by a qualitative assessment of whether a business activity has a core involvement in power generation. A higher involvement will result in a higher exposure score for the business activity.

Geographic Exposure score

The Geographic Exposure score is a weighted average of the Geographic Segment Exposure scores of the countries, markets and regions in which a company operates. scores are weighted by the proportion of a company's total revenue in each geographic segment through the following equation:

$$GEO_{ORE,i} = \sum_{r=1}^{n_i} w_{Revenue,i,r} GSE_{ORE,r}$$

Where:

- $GSE_{ORE,r}$ is the Geographic Segment Exposure score in region r for company i.
- $w_{Revenue,i,r}$ is the weight of total revenue in region r for company i.
- n_i is the number of geographic segments for company i.

For geographic segments reported as regions (example: Asia Pacific), a nominal GDP-weighted country or market aggregation is used to calculate region-level scores, using the following equation:

$$GSE_{ORE,r} = \sum_{c=1}^{n_r} w_{GDP,r,c} GSE_{ORE,c}$$

Where:

- $GSE_{ORE,r}$ is the Geographic Segment Exposure score of region r.

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- $GSE_{ORE,c}$ is the Geographic Segment Exposure score of country or market c.
- $w_{GDP,r,c}$ is the specific weight of country or market c within region r.

Geographic Segment Exposure scores

The Geographic Segment Exposure score is determined by the incentives provided by a country or market to expand renewable power generation capacity.

$$GSE_{ORE,c} = TI_c + REO_c$$

Where:

- TI_c is the Total Incentives score for country or market c.
- REO_c is the Renewable Energy Outlook for country or market c.

The following types of regulatory, fiscal and public financing incentives are considered for the Total Incentives score:

1. Feed-in tariffs
2. Tradable energy certificates
3. Renewable portfolio standards
4. Capital subsidies, grants or rebates
5. Investment tax credits
6. Sales tax credits
7. Tax exemptions/reductions
8. Public investment loans
9. Public competitive bidding

The Total Incentives score measures the number of incentives provided by a country. Provision of more incentives results in a higher opportunity score for a country or market.

The Renewable Energy Outlook for a country or market is based on a qualitative assessment by MSCI on the planned renewable capacity additions and investments in renewable power generation in the country or market.

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Data sources

The following sources are used to determine the Opportunities in Renewable Energy Exposure score:

Refinitiv, MSCI S&C, company disclosures, Renewable Energy Policy Network for the 21st Century.

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